THE MARINE ENVIRONMENT PROTECTION COMMITTEE, RECALLING Article 38(a) of the Convention o n the International Maritime Organization concerning the functions of the Marine Environ ment Protection Committee (the Committee) conferred upon it by international conventions for the prevention and control of marine pollution, NOTING article 16 of the Inlernalion al Convention for the Prevention of Pollution from - conferred upon it by international conventions for the prevention and control of marine pollution, NOTING article 16 of the Inlernalional Convention for the Prevention of Pollution from Ships, 1973 (hereinafter r eferred to as the "1973 Convention"), article VI of the Protocol of 1978 relating 10 Ihe International Convention for the Prevention of Pollution from Ships, 1973 (hereinafter r eferred to as the "1978 Protocol") and article 4 of the Protocol of 1997 10 amend the In ternational Convention for the Prevention of Pollution from Ships, 1973, as modified by the Protocol of 1978 relating thereto (hereinafter referred to as the "1997 Protocol"), which together specify the amendment procedure of the 1997 Protocol and confer upon the appropriate body of Ihe Organization the function of considering and adopting amendments to the 1973 Convention , as modif